

Becoming Gutenberg

Say have you heard of Gutenberg?

Who? Johannes? Oh yes.
He's a German goldsmith.

No, I'm pretty sure
he is a blacksmith.

Excuse me. No.
He's a publisher!

Gutenberg is a printer!
How do you not know that?



Well, he does seem to have spread
knowledge to the masses!

What do you mean?

There would have been no
Renaissance, no Reformation,
no Age of Enlightenment and no
Scientific Revolution without him!

Whoa! Really?



Flashback. It is the year 1439. Gutenberg has chanced upon the movable type.

Umm... what is this supposed to do?

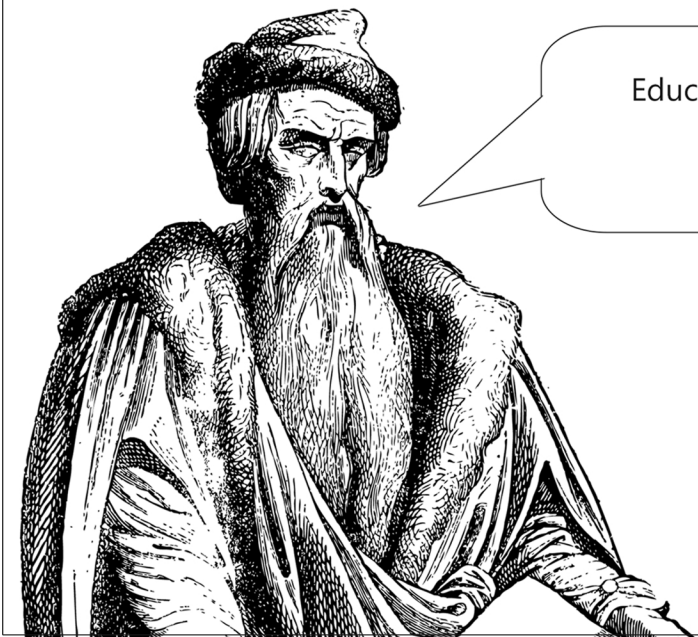
Mass produce printed books!

And what is it made of?

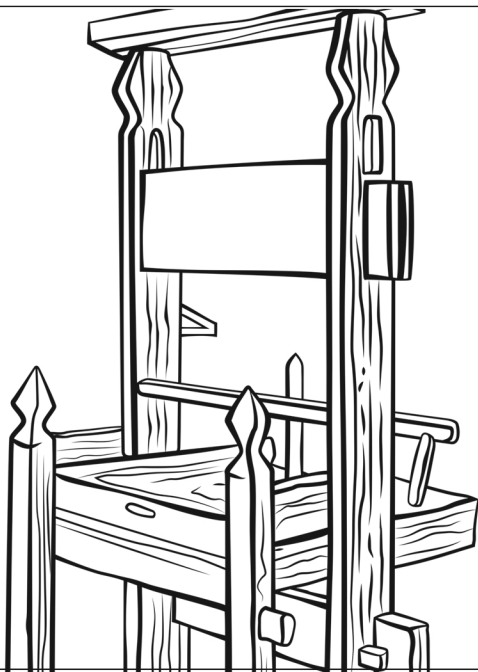
It is an alloy of lead, tin and antimony! We shall call it type metal!



Education would no longer be for the elite! Anyone can read a book!
Latin would no longer be the main language!
European languages would flourish too!



Soon, printing started on an industrial scale and the middle class emerged with increased access to books.



Hey, there goes Gutenberg!
The famous Gutenberg!
Do you know where he's from?



Well, actually I know very
little about his past.



I know he was born in Mainz, Germany to an upper class merchant.
And that he grew up with a lot of knowledge about goldsmithing!
I know he and his family later migrated to Strasbourg
for political reasons. The rest of his youth is a mystery!



Meanwhile, in 1450, Gutenberg prints his first, a German poem!

Worry not, Gutenberg! Johann Fust will come to
your rescue with a loan of 800 guilders!





It is 1455 and Johannes has completed his 42-line Bible, known as Gutenberg Bible. 180 copies are printed. Some on paper and some on vellum.

